

Career Horizon Compression

Career horizon refers to the expected number of remaining working years available to an individual at any point in their career. Mandatory retirement rules define this horizon ex ante.

Empirical context: expected working life

In the European Union, the average expected duration of working life in 2024 was 37.2 years, with a clear gender gap:

- Men: 39.2 years
- Women: 35.0 years
- Gender gap: 4.2 years

Over the past decade, expected working life has increased across most EU countries, reflecting longevity gains and delayed labor market exit. However, the gender gap persists and varies substantially across countries. Finland recorded one of the smallest gaps (0.6 years), while Italy exhibited one of the largest (9.0 years).

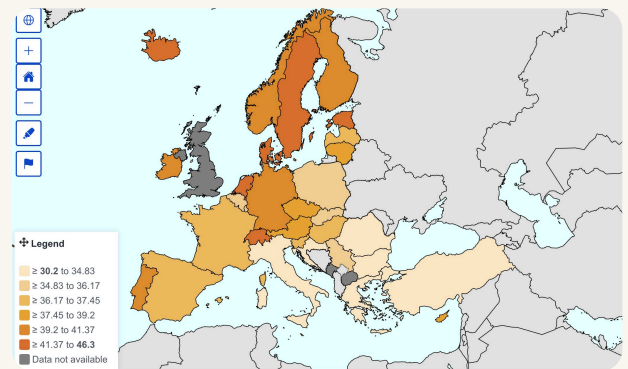


Figure 2 illustrates the cross-country variation in expected working life in Europe.

[Screenshot From Eurostat Official Website](#)

